Sam Nicholson

hello@s-nicholson.co.uk
s-nicholson.co.uk

Experienced full-stack software engineer focused on backend systems, developer productivity and shipping reliable systems.

What I'm looking for

- Small, fast-moving engineering team,
- Mostly remote (limited hybrid acceptable),
- Individual contributor role - prefer hands-on to "management" roles,
- Opportunities to learn and influence engineering practice,
- Ethical product and team culture.

Experience

Senior Backend Engineer **MrQ** **Feb 2026 - Present**
Backend developer in the Platform Tribe

- A few different :sparkles:AI:sparkles: bits and pieces:
    - in-house Code Review agent,
    - infra modules to integrate models in our services,
    - MCP Gateway for internal agents,
    - building patterns for new MCPs and agents to make adoption easier for other teams,
- Migrating services from legacy cloud provider to EKS - service code and config changes, new supporting infra in terraform, migrating data from old DBs to new RDS.
- Grafana onboarding and tuning for cost optimisation.

Technologies: *AI, kotlin, java, aws, eks, bedrock, redis, mongodb, terraform, gradle, jenkins, github actions, linear*

Senior Consultant **Accenture NGE** **Nov 2021 - Jan 2026**
Various client accounts (Public and Private sector)

- Delivered multiple client projects as an IC/tech lead: event-driven Java Lambdas (Spring Cloud Functions) deployed via CDK; platform tooling for federated GraphQL; Kotlin Spring Boot microservices for telemetry.
- Involved in all aspects of projects - architecture, dev, test, docs, support - across multiple teams.
- Improving team productivity by mentoring, fixing broken environments/pipelines, fixing long-standing issues.

Technologies: *Java, Kotlin, TypeScript, AWS (Lambda, ECS, SQS, DynamoDB), CDK, Terraform, Kubernetes, Kafka, Spring, Gradle, Maven, Jenkins, Git*

Senior Software Engineer **FanDuel** **Apr 2020 - Nov 2021**
Responsible Gaming and Regulatory Reporting

- Owned Regulatory Reporting service: delivered new features, improved reliability and reduced heavy report runtimes by ~90%.
- Acted as SME for Reporting and on-call support across Account & Wallet vertical; onboarded contractors and handed over.

Technologies: *Java, Python, MySQL, AWS, Terraform, Gradle, Jenkins, Guice, Hibernate, Git*

Senior Software Engineer **Pinsent Masons** **Jan 2018 - Apr 2020**
SmartDelivery

- Maintained and improved SmartDelivery apps (C# webapp + Java forms engine). Rewrote key screens to improve UX and page load times.
- Introduced GitFlow and improved documentation/processes to reduce friction for users and the team.

Technologies: *C#, Java, JavaScript, MSSQL, MongoDB, Maven, Gradle, Git, Spring*

Software Engineer **BT** **Sep 2014 - Jul 2017**
Energy

- Developed the PEMS application for energy participation in grid schemes.
- Built a data-driven query framework enabling faster stakeholder reporting without releases.

Technologies: *Java, Bash, Oracle, PL/SQL, Maven, Jenkins*

Skills

- **Languages:** Java, Kotlin, C#, TypeScript, Python, Shell, JavaScript
- **Backend & Frameworks:** Spring Boot, Spring Cloud Functions, Guice, Hibernate
- **Cloud & Infra:** AWS (Lambda, ECS, SQS, DynamoDB), CDK, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, Jenkins
- **Data & Messaging:** Kafka, MySQL, Postgres, MongoDB, DynamoDB
- **Tools:** Git, Gradle, Maven, Ansible, CI/CD pipelines, observability & testing frameworks

Education and Certs

- **B.Sc. Computer Science,** Newcastle University. **2010–2014**
  - Incl. Industrial Placement, BT 2012-2013
- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate** **Apr 2022**